

Era Name	Time-Range	Main Focus / Theme	Key Technologies & Platform Shifts	Notable Companies / Innovations	Business Model Trends	Why it Matters
Mainframe / Time-Sharing Era	1960s-1970s	Centralised computing; users share big machines	Time-sharing systems, mainframes, terminals	IBM's CTSS & 360 systems. (saaslucid.com)	Utility computing, cost-sharing	Set foundation for remote access and “computing as a service”
PC / Client-Server Era	1980s-1990s	Desktop PCs, local installs, client-server networks	Personal computers, networks, client-server architecture	Microsoft (Windows), spreadsheets, enterprise apps. (en.wikipedia.org)	Perpetual licensing, on-premises deployment	Shifted computing from mainframes to every desk
Internet / Web Era (Web 1.0 → Web 2.0)	~1990-2000	Birth of the Web, websites, early e-commerce	HTML, browsers, early web apps, web hosting	Netscape, early Amazon, Yahoo!	Advertising + e-commerce models; free content + web services	Opened the internet to mainstream business and consumers
SaaS & Cloud Foundations Era	~2000-2010	Software delivered over the web via subscription	Broadband, early virtualization, multi-tenant cloud, ASP → SaaS. (publishingpitaara.com)	Salesforce (1999), early Google Apps	Subscription licensing, SaaS platform model	Transformed how software is bought/used: from install to access
Mobile-Cloud & Platform Era	~2010-2018	Mobile-first apps, platforms, big data, API economy	Smartphones (iOS/Android), React/Node.js, cloud APIs, IoT	Uber, Airbnb, Slack, Stripe, mobile ecosystems	Platform-based business models, freemium + subscriptions	Enabled global scale, new business models (sharing economy, platforms)
AI-Augmented SaaS / Intelligence Era	~2019-Present	AI integrated into nearly all software; generative AI, intelligent assistants	Large language models (LLMs), cloud GPUs, vector databases, automation workflows	OpenAI, Hugging Face, vertical-AI-SaaS startups	Usage-based pricing, outcome-based contracts, AI-as-a-Service (AlaaS)	Software moves from tool to “assistant/partner”; AI becomes range-condition
Agentic / Autonomous Software Era (Emerging)	~2025/26-2035	Autonomous agents, self-operating workflows, “software that runs itself”	Multi-agent systems, reinforcement learning, synthetic data, hyper-automation	Futuristic: autonomous enterprise agents, self-driving business workflows	Outcome-based billing, software as autonomous service, “robotic software workforce”	Major shift: software begins to act, decide & operate rather than just assist

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Ubiquitous Compute & Immersive Experience Era (Projected)	~2030-2040	Seamless computing embedded everywhere: ambient, pervasive, immersive (XR/Metaverse)	Edge computing, AR/VR/Spatial computing, quantum clouds, brain-computer interfaces	Future tech leaders & ecosystems	Subscription + “experience” models, continuous immersive service	Computing becomes entirely ambient — “software everywhere”